

Mutahar Ali

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EDUCATION

University of California, Irvine (UCI)

Ph.D. Computer Science

- Advised by Prof. Habiba Farrukh
- Research Area: Security and Privacy of Emerging Computing Technologies

M.S. Computer Science

- CGPA: 4.00/4.00

Irvine, CA, USA

Sept. 2024 – Present

Lahore University of Management Sciences (LUMS)

BS Computer Science

- Graduated with Distinction
- Placed on Dean's Honor List (2019-2022)
- CGPA: 3.74

Lahore, Pakistan

Aug. 2019 – June 2023

WORK EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Researcher

Security and Privacy of Emerging Computing Technologies (SPECT) Lab, UCI

Sept. 2024 – Present

Irvine, CA, USA

Research Associate

Internet and Data Systems Lab (IDSL), LUMS

Jul. 2023 – Aug. 2024

Lahore, Pakistan

GenAI and Software Engineer

ActualAIz

Jul. 2023 – Aug. 2024

Lahore, Pakistan

Undergraduate Research Assistant

Networks and Systems Group (NSG), LUMS

Jun. 2021 – May 2023

Lahore, Pakistan

CONFERENCE PUBLICATIONS

[C1] Understanding Users' Perceptions of Client-Side Modifications and Anti-Cheat Engines in Social XR

Iman Mohammadi*, [Mutahar Ali](#)*, Habiba Farrukh [*Equal Contribution]

ACM Conference on Computer and Communications Security (CCS), 2026

[C2] Relay and Betray: Exploiting Client-Side Authority in Multi-User Mixed Reality

[Mutahar Ali](#), Habiba Farrukh

USENIX Security Symposium, 2026 [\[PDF\]](#) [\[Code\]](#) [\[Poster\]](#)

[C3] Understanding Users' S&P Attitudes Towards Conversational AI Platforms

[Mutahar Ali](#), Arjun Arunasalam, Habiba Farrukh

IEEE Symposium on Security and Privacy (S&P), 2025 [\[PDF\]](#) [\[Code\]](#) [\[Poster\]](#)

[C4] Warping the Edge: Where Instant Mobility in 5G Meets Stateful Applications

Mukhtiar Ahmad, Faaiz Bilal, [Mutahar Ali](#), Muhammad Ali Nawazish, Amir Salman, Shazer Ali, Fawad Ahmad, Zafar Ayyub Qazi

ACM/IEEE Symposium on Edge Computing (SEC), 2025 [\[PDF\]](#)

WORKSHOP PUBLICATIONS

[W1] Agentic Framework for Automated Security Analysis in Multi-User Extended Reality

[Mutahar Ali](#), Habiba Farrukh

Workshop on Enhancing Security, Privacy, and Trust in Extended Reality (XR) Systems (XR Security), 2026

POSTERS

[P1] **PeekXR: Understanding Privacy Leakages from Eye Gaze in Extended Reality**
Chuyang Peng, Mutahar Ali, Habiba Farrukh
ACM International Conference on Mobile Systems, Applications, and Services (MobiSys), 2025 [PDF] [Poster] [Best Poster Runner-Up]

PRE-PRINTS

Follow My Eyes: Backdoor Attacks on Goal-Directed Scanpath Prediction
Diana Romero*, Mutahar Ali*, Momin Khan*, Habiba Farrukh, Fatima Anwar, Salma Elmalaki [*Equal Contribution]
arXiv:2604.08766, 2026 [PDF]

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Teaching Assistant <i>University of California, Irvine (UCI)</i> - CS-130: Introduction to Security & Privacy (Spring 2025, Spring 2026) - CS-141: Concepts in Programming Languages (Fall 2025)	March 2025 - Present <i>Irvine, CA, USA</i>
Undergraduate Teaching Assistant <i>Lahore University of Management Sciences (LUMS)</i> CS-382: Network-Centric Computing (Spring 2022, Spring 2023)	Jan 2022 – May 2023 <i>Lahore, Pakistan</i>

SERVICE

- **Artifact Evaluation Committee (AEC)**
 - IEEE Security and Privacy (S&P) 2026
 - ACM Conference on Computer and Communications Security (CCS), 2026
- **Student Volunteer**
 - ACM International Conference on Mobile Systems, Applications, and Services (MobiSys), 2025

HONORS AND AWARDS

- USENIX Security Student Travel Grant (2026)
- UCI Computer Science Department Research Fellowship (2024-2025)
- Graduated with Distinction, BS Computer Science, LUMS (2023)
- Students as Co-Researchers Grant, LUMS (2022)
- Dean’s Honor List, BS Computer Science, LUMS (2019–2022)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages:	Python, C, C++, C#, JavaScript/TypeScript, Go, Haskell
Security:	Frida, Ghidra, mitmproxy, Burp Suite, Wireshark, dnSpy, adb
Extended Reality:	Unity, Unreal, OpenXR, Photon
ML & Data Science:	PyTorch, HuggingFace Transformers, vLLM, Whisper, MCP, OpenCV, Pandas, Matplotlib
Development:	Next.js, React.js, Node.js, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Selenium
DevOps:	Docker, LXC, AWS
Miscellaneous:	Git, Bash, Jupyter, LaTeX